

of the Lie. It is worked out in the later fancy which conceives the damned so close together that they seemed an indistinguishable mass; yet in the darkness each ever wails, "I am alone!" The symbolism of Fire was kept out of this eschatology for obvious reasons. It was left to the imagination of Milton to combine the symbols:—

A dungeon horrible on all sides round
As one great furnace flamed, yet from those flames
No light, but rather darkness visible.

The picture is quite in the spirit of the Gathas. The basis of the darkness motive was very likely Aryan. In the *R̥gveda* (vii. 104³) hell is a place of darkness in the depths of the earth. We have seen already (p. 128 f.) how the evil spirit was imagined before Zarathushtra to dwell below as "the god underground," in the phrase of Herodotus. The Prophet, then, is using again imagery made ready for him. But as usual he takes care to stamp it with his own hallmark, and make it clear that imagery is only meant to impress ideas that are wholly of the mind.

If ideas of space are left intentionally vague, we soon find that those of time are defined with vivid clearness. There are three different phrases to indicate the duration of future reward and punishment. A typical passage is *Ys* 45⁷.

He whose awards, whereof he ordains, men shall attain
whoso are living or have been or shall be. In eternity
(*aməratāitī*) shall the soul (*urvā*) of the righteous be
happy, in perpetuity (*utayūtā*) the torments of the men of
the Lie. All this doth Mazdah Ahura appoint by his
Dominion.